

KORE.AI COMPETITIVE INTELLIGENCE

# Competitive Signal Report

Topic: Enterprise agentic AI & contact-center AI (CCAI) · Window: last 72h · Thursday, 20 August 2026 · 08:28 IST  
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**Bottom line:** Competitors are pushing forward with agentic AI capabilities, particularly in voice and integration, but gaps in analyst validation and predictable pricing persist. Kore.ai's strength in true omnichannel, deterministic execution, and proven analyst leadership remains a key differentiator against these moves.

## Glean Expands Partner Network, Targets Pilot Model Disruption

**WHAT HAPPENED**  
(2026-08-19) Glean announced the launch of its Global Partner Network, aiming to broaden its reach, and co-founder Tim Glomb is set to challenge the "AI for Work" pilot model at their upcoming Glean:GO 2026 event. [EIN NEWS](#) [WHAT IT MEANS FOR KORE.AI](#)  
Glean's focus on enterprise AI for work, while not directly CX-focused, signals a broader market trend towards agentic AI adoption. Kore.ai's established CX leadership and robust platform, validated by analysts, positions us to capture enterprise AI budgets seeking proven, customer-facing solutions, unlike Glean's employee-facing focus.

## Salesforce Agentforce Explores Financial Services Value Proposition

**WHAT HAPPENED**  
(2026-08-19) Salesforce published an article questioning the value of upgrading to Agentforce specifically for Financial Services, highlighting its potential benefits. [Salesforce](#) [WHAT IT MEANS FOR KORE.AI](#)  
Salesforce's internal discussion about Agentforce's value proposition, especially in a regulated vertical like Financial Services, underscores potential hesitations around its maturity and specific applicability. Kore.ai's ABL framework and compile-time validation offer deterministic and auditable AI for regulated industries, directly addressing concerns that Agentforce may still be navigating.

## IBM watsonx Orchestrate Enhances Agent Capabilities with New Integrations

**WHAT HAPPENED**  
(2026-08-19) IBM announced that watsonx Orchestrate is closing the gap between building and running agents, with new capabilities to facilitate this process. [IBM](#) [WHAT IT MEANS FOR KORE.AI](#)  
IBM is focusing on the operationalization of agents, a key area where Kore.ai's ABL excels with its compile-time validation and Git-native release engineering. While IBM emphasizes integration, Kore.ai's platform provides a more robust, end-to-end solution for building, testing, and deploying reliable agents, particularly for complex enterprise use cases requiring determinism.

AT A GLANCE

### Signal priority table

| Competitor | Move (dated) | Threat | Kore.ai counter |
|------------|--------------|--------|-----------------|
|------------|--------------|--------|-----------------|

|                         |                                                                                                  |      |                                                                                   |
|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Glean                   | (2026-08-19) Launched Global Partner Network & challenges pilot model — <a href="#">EIN News</a> | Low  | Proven CX leadership vs. employee-facing focus                                    |
| Salesforce (Agentforce) | (2026-08-19) Explores FS value proposition for Agentforce — <a href="#">Salesforce</a>           | Med  | Deterministic AI for regulated industries vs. Agentforce's evolving applicability |
| IBM Agent Platform      | (2026-08-19) Enhances agent build/run capabilities — <a href="#">IBM</a>                         | Med  | Compile-time validation & end-to-end platform vs. IBM's integration focus         |
| PolyAI                  | (2026-08-18) Direct integration with Epic for healthcare — <a href="#">PR Newswire</a>           | High | True omnichannel voice & digital vs. PolyAI's voice-first approach                |
| NICE (Cognigy)          | (2026-08-18) Bluecrest deploys NICE AI platform — <a href="#">IT Brief UK</a>                    | High | Proven analyst leadership in CAI vs. NICE's CCaaS-centric positioning             |
| Genesys                 | (2026-08-17) Five9 launches AI Voice Agent integration — <a href="#">webull.com</a>              | Med  | Deterministic AI vs. Genesys's reliance on third-party voice/AI                   |

ON THE RADAR

Watch for

- Continued expansion of partner networks by companies like Glean, indicating a push for broader market reach.
- Salesforce's ongoing efforts to articulate Agentforce's specific value in regulated industries.
- IBM's progress in integrating its watsonx Orchestrate with contact center solutions.

SO WHAT — DO THIS NOW

Recommended actions

- Emphasize Kore.ai's leadership in analyst evaluations for Conversational AI Platforms, particularly against competitors who are not Leaders in this specific category.
- Highlight ABL's compile-time validation and deterministic execution as key differentiators for regulated industries, directly countering potential concerns with Salesforce Agentforce.
- Reinforce Kore.ai's true omnichannel capabilities (voice and digital) as a superior alternative to voice-first or voice-only solutions like PolyAI.
- Position Kore.ai as the enterprise-grade, proven platform for agentic AI in CX, contrasting with the operationalization challenges and potential TCO unpredictability of competitors like IBM.

EVIDENCE TRAIL

Sources

- (2026-08-19) Glean Expands Partner Network, Targets Pilot Model Disruption — [EIN News](#)
- (2026-08-19) Is It Worth Upgrading to Agentforce for Financial Services? — [Salesforce](#)
- (2026-08-19) IBM Bob and watsonx Orchestrate close the gap between building and running agents — [IBM](#)
- (2026-08-18) PolyAI launches direct integration with Epic, with PDS Health among the first to deploy at scale — [PR Newswire](#)
- (2026-08-18) Bluecrest boosts contact centre with NiCE AI platform — [IT Brief UK](#)
- (2026-08-17) Five9 (FIVN) Launches AI Voice Agent Integration For Regulated Contact Centers — [webull.com](#)